

PayMongo Client Configuration Guide



Dashboard setup, test payment, webhook, and safe live launch

Prepared for: Rental by Maddy & Cassy

The short version

Your client completes PayMongo verification, enables the payment methods, adds the keys and webhook settings in Vercel, tests one booking, then replaces the test credentials with live credentials after approval.

1. What the client must prepare

- Business owner's valid government ID and access to the registered email/phone.
- Business registration and tax documents requested by PayMongo for the chosen account type.
- Bank account details for settlements/payouts, matching the verified business or owner.
- Final website address: <https://maddyandcassyrentals-nine.vercel.app> (replace this if a custom domain is adopted).

Security action before live launch

Regenerate any secret key that has appeared in a screenshot, chat, email, or public repository. Never place `sk_test_...`, `sk_live_...`, or `whsk_...` values in the website's frontend code.

2. Configure the PayMongo account

- 1. Complete identity verification** — Log in to the PayMongo Dashboard and finish the email OTP, liveness check, government ID, and personal information requested on screen.
- 2. Complete the business profile** — Use the legal name from the registration documents. For the trade name, use "Rental by Maddy & Cassy." Describe the business as daily rentals of phones, cameras, and related equipment through an online reservation website.
- 3. Submit business verification** — Upload only the documents PayMongo requests for the selected entity type. Make sure names, addresses, and registration numbers match across all documents.
- 4. Add settlement details** — Enter the verified bank account in the payout or wallet settings. Double-check the account name and number before saving.
- 5. Activate payment methods** — Open Payment Channels and request/enable GCash, Cards, and QR Ph. A method will only appear at checkout when PayMongo has made it available to the account.

Suggested business-profile answers

Field	Recommended entry
Trade name	Rental by Maddy & Cassy
Website	https://maddyandcassyr rentals-nine.vercel.app , or the final custom domain
Business description	Online daily rental of smartphones, cameras, and related equipment, with scheduled pickup or delivery.
Industry	Choose the closest available rental, retail, electronics, or consumer-services category.
Contact details	Use the official business email, mobile number, and complete operating address.

3. Connect test mode to the website

- 1. Switch to Test Mode** — Use the Test/Live toggle in the PayMongo Dashboard.
- 2. Copy test API keys** — Open Developers → API Keys. Copy the test public key and test secret key. Keep the secret key private.
- 3. Add the values in Vercel** — Open the Vercel project → Settings → Environment Variables. Add these values to Production, Preview, and Development only as needed, then save.

Vercel variable	Test value format	What it controls
NEXT_PUBLIC_PAYMONGO_PUBLIC_KEY	pk_test_...	Safe for the browser; use the test public key.
PAYMONGO_SECRET_KEY	sk_test_...	Private server key. Never send in chat or place in frontend code.
PAYMONGO_WEBHOOK_SECRET	whsk_...	Copy from the test webhook you created.
PAYMONGO_PAYMENT_METHODS	gcash, card, qrph	Only include methods enabled for the account.
NEXT_PUBLIC_APP_URL	https://maddyandcassyr rentals-nine.vercel.app	Use the final production/custom domain if it changes.

- 4. Create the test webhook** — In PayMongo Test Mode, open Developers → Webhooks → Create Webhook. Use the endpoint below and subscribe to `checkout_session.payment.paid`.

<https://maddyandcassyr rentals-nine.vercel.app/api/paymongo/webhook>

- 5. Copy the webhook secret** — Add the generated `whsk_...` value to `PAYMONGO_WEBHOOK_SECRET` in Vercel.
- 6. Redeploy** — Vercel must create a new deployment after environment variables change. Open Deployments, use the latest deployment menu, and select Redeploy—or push a harmless new commit.

4. Test the complete payment flow

- ☐ Open the deployed website, create or sign in to a customer account, and start a new reservation.

- ☐ Choose 50% or full payment and click Continue to PayMongo.
- ☐ Select an available test payment method. For e-wallet tests, choose Authorize on PayMongo's simulation page.
- ☐ Return to the merchant. The booking must resume instead of returning to a blank or login-only state.
- ☐ Confirm the booking shows Payment received/verified and that a receipt appears under the customer's booking.
- ☐ Open PayMongo → Developers → Webhooks and confirm the event received a successful response.

Important QR Ph test warning

PayMongo's current testing documentation warns that test-mode QR Ph can generate a real QR code. Do not scan and pay it. Use PayMongo's provided test simulation link instead.

5. Move from test to live

- 1. Wait for activation** — Confirm business verification is approved and the required payment channels are active in Live Mode.
- 2. Regenerate live credentials** — Open Developers → API Keys in Live Mode. Rotate any live secret that was previously exposed.
- 3. Create a separate live webhook** — Create it while the dashboard is in Live Mode, using the same production endpoint and checkout_session.payment.paid event. Test and live webhooks are separate.
- 4. Replace production values in Vercel** — Use pk_live_..., sk_live_..., and the live webhook's whsk_.... Do not retain test keys in Production.
- 5. Redeploy and run a small real payment** — Use a low-value booking, verify the PayMongo payment, webhook delivery, receipt, and booking status, then refund or reconcile it according to the business process.

Live launch rule

A PayMongo checkout page opening is not enough. Launch only after the website receives the paid webhook and records the correct booking and receipt.

6. Tutorial videos and visual references

These videos are useful for seeing the flow. PayMongo's current official documentation, linked below, is the final reference because dashboard labels and API behavior can change.

1

[PayMongo API Tutorial Part 2 — Registering to PayMongo \[Tagalog\]](#)

Best for visually understanding account creation and initial registration.

Published in 2021; the current dashboard may look different.

2

[PayMongo API Tutorial Part 3 — Creating a Payment Source \[Tagalog\]](#)

Shows the customer redirection/authorization idea behind an e-wallet payment.

Conceptual only for this project; Rental by Maddy & Cassy uses PayMongo Hosted Checkout Sessions.

3

PayMongo API Tutorial Part 4 — Webhook and Payment [Tagalog]

Useful for understanding why the webhook—not the browser return page—confirms a payment.

Published in 2021; follow the current dashboard webhook steps in this guide.

4

Online Payment Method Using PHP and PayMongo

A newer visual example of checkout plus real-time webhook handling.

The programming language differs from this Next.js system, so use it only to visualize the payment lifecycle.

Current official visual guides

- [Create and verify a PayMongo account](#)
- [Hosted Checkout quick start](#)
- [Create a webhook in the dashboard](#)
- [Test cards, e-wallets, and QR Ph](#)
- [PayMongo Dashboard Mastery Hub](#)

7. Fast troubleshooting

Problem	What to check
No payment methods appear	Check Live/Test mode, channel activation, PAYMONGO_PAYMENT_METHODS, and redeploy Vercel.
Secure checkout cannot be created	Confirm the server secret key matches the current mode and contains no spaces or quotation marks.
Payment succeeds but booking stays pending	Check the webhook mode, endpoint, event selection, secret, and latest Vercel function logs.
Customer returns to login	Confirm NEXT_PUBLIC_APP_URL matches the deployed domain and that the user is returning to the same domain used to start the booking.
Webhook shows failed delivery	Open the event in PayMongo, inspect the response, fix the endpoint, then resend the event if the dashboard offers that action.

Client handoff checklist

- ☐ PayMongo identity and business verification approved
- ☐ Settlement bank account confirmed
- ☐ GCash, Cards, and QR Ph status reviewed
- ☐ Test keys and test webhook configured in Vercel
- ☐ Full test booking completed and recorded
- ☐ Exposed secret keys rotated
- ☐ Live keys and live webhook configured

☐ Small live transaction verified end to end

Keep all secret credentials in PayMongo and Vercel—not in chat, screenshots, or source control.

Launch sign-off record

Client/merchant representative	Technical representative
PayMongo verification approved on	Live payment channels confirmed
Test booking reference	Live verification transaction reference
Client approval/signature	Date

After launch: simple monthly checks

- Review failed payments and failed webhook deliveries.
- Reconcile PayMongo settlements against recorded booking receipts.
- Confirm the live payment channels still appear at checkout.
- Remove access for former staff and rotate a key immediately if it may have been exposed.